

Sorting and Filtering

Definition

Sorting means arranging data in a specific order.

It helps organize data so that it becomes easier to read, analyze, and compare.

For example:

Before Sorting

Student Marks

Rahul 78

Anita 95

John 65

Priya 88

After Sorting (Largest to Smallest)

Student Marks

Anita 95

Priya 88

Rahul 78

John 65

Now you can immediately identify the top-performing student.

Why Do We Use Sorting?

Sorting helps to:

- Find highest or lowest values
- Arrange names alphabetically
- Arrange dates chronologically
- Organize employee records
- Prepare reports
- Analyze data quickly

Types of Sorting

1. Alphabetical Sorting (A → Z)

Used for text.

Example:

Before

Orange

Apple

Banana

Mango

After

Apple

Banana

Mango

Orange

2. Reverse Alphabetical (Z → A)

Orange

Mango

Banana

Apple

3. Smallest to Largest

Used for numbers.

Before

45

12

89

30

After

12

30

45

89

4. Largest to Smallest

89

45

30

12

Useful for:

- Highest salary
 - Highest marks
 - Top sales
-

5. Oldest to Newest

Used for dates.

Example

15-Jan

5-Feb

20-Jan

After

15-Jan

20-Jan

5-Feb

6. Newest to Oldest

Reverse date sorting.

Useful for:

- Latest orders
 - Recent transactions
 - Attendance records
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Example Dataset

Employee Department Salary Experience

Rahul IT 45000 2

Anita HR 60000 5

John IT 30000 1

Priya Sales 55000 4

Employee Department Salary Experience

Neha	HR	50000	3
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We will use this table throughout the lesson.

How to Sort (Step by Step)

Method 1 – Quick Sort

Step 1

Click any cell in the column you want to sort.

Example:

Click any salary value.

Step 2

Go to

Data → Sort Smallest to Largest

or

Sort Largest to Smallest

Step 3

Excel rearranges the entire table, not just the selected column.

This keeps all related data together.

Important Rule

- ✔ Always select the entire dataset or click inside the dataset.
 - ✗ Never select only one column and sort it, because names, salaries, and departments may become mismatched.
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Custom Sort (Sorting by Multiple Columns)

Suppose you want to:

1. Sort Department alphabetically.
2. Then sort Salary from Highest to Lowest.

Step 1

Select any cell in the table.

Step 2

Go to:

Data → Sort

The Sort dialog box opens.

Step 3

Choose:

Sort by: Department

Order:

A → Z

Step 4

Click

Add Level

Choose

Salary

Largest to Smallest

Step 5

Click OK.

Result

HR employees appear together, sorted by salary.

Then IT employees appear together, sorted by salary.

Then Sales employees.

This is called Multi-Level Sorting.

Sorting by Cell Color

Suppose

Green = Completed

Red = Pending

Steps:

Data → Sort

Sort On → Cell Color

Choose Green

Click OK

All green rows move together.

Sorting by Font Color

If text is:

Blue

Red

Black

You can arrange rows according to font color.

Sorting by Icon

If Conditional Formatting uses icons such as:



Excel can sort based on these icons.

What is Filtering?

Definition

Filtering means showing only the records that match a condition, while hiding the others.

No data is deleted.

Only the matching rows remain visible.

Example

Employee Department

Rahul	IT
Anita	HR
John	IT
Neha	Sales

Filter:

Department = IT

Result

Employee Department

Rahul	IT
John	IT

Why Use Filtering?

Filtering helps you:

- Find specific employees
- View one department
- Show only high salaries
- Display a particular month
- Search large datasets quickly

How to Apply a Filter (Step by Step)

Step 1

Select the entire table.

Step 2

Go to

Data → Filter

or press:

Ctrl + Shift + L

Small dropdown arrows appear in each header.

Step 3

Click the dropdown in the column you want to filter.

Example:

Department

Step 4

Uncheck Select All.

Select only:

IT

Click OK.

Only IT employees remain visible.

How to Clear a Filter

Click the dropdown.

Choose:

Clear Filter from Department

or

Go to

Data → Clear

All rows become visible again.

Text Filters

Click the filter arrow in a text column.

Choose Text Filters.

Options include:

- Equals
- Does Not Equal
- Begins With
- Ends With
- Contains

- Does Not Contain

Example

Names beginning with A

Result:

Anita

Arjun

Number Filters

Available for numeric columns.

Options include:

- Equals
- Greater Than
- Less Than
- Between
- Top 10
- Above Average
- Below Average

Example

Salary > 50,000

Shows only employees earning more than ₹50,000.

Date Filters

Available for date columns.

Options include:

- Today
- Yesterday
- This Week
- Last Week
- This Month
- Last Month
- This Year

- Next Year
- Between Dates

Example:

Show only orders from January.

Filter by Color

If rows are color-coded:

Green = Completed

Yellow = In Progress

Red = Pending

You can display only one color.

Search Box in Filter

Suppose there are 5,000 employee names.

Instead of scrolling:

Type:

Rahul

Excel instantly finds Rahul.

Difference Between Sorting and Filtering

Sorting	Filtering
Rearranges data	Hides unwanted rows
Changes row order	Keeps row order the same
Displays all records	Displays only matching records
Used for organization	Used for searching and analysis

Shortcut	Purpose
Ctrl + Shift + L	Apply or remove Filter
Alt + D + S	Open Sort dialog (classic shortcut)
Ctrl + A	Select all data
Ctrl + Z	Undo the last action